

EASTER OFFENSIVE TO US EXIT

JANUARY 1972—JANUARY 1973

At Easter 1972, North Vietnam launched a major offensive against the South, using tanks and heavy artillery. The North Vietnamese Army struck southward across the DMZ to capture Quang Tri and across South Vietnam's western borders toward Kontum and An Loc. The United States responded with extensive bombing of the North and provided air support for South Vietnamese ground troops. After initial reverses, the South Vietnamese army halted the offensive on all fronts. In the fall, the Paris peace talks broke down after coming tantalizingly close to agreement, prompting President Richard Nixon to order air raids by B-52 bombers against key targets in Hanoi and Haiphong. A resumption of negotiations in January 1973 brought swift agreement on terms for a ceasefire and the final withdrawal of American forces from Vietnam.